

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 17 Summary

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In the previous lesson, we focused on *gustar* and how to say you like things using indirect object pronouns. In this lesson, we go further and learn how to express deeper feelings like **loving things or people** and how to avoid misunderstandings when talking about liking **people or pets**.

Liking and Loving Things:

You already know how to say you like something using *gustar*: *Me gusta el café*.

To express stronger feelings, you now add:

- **Encantar** – to love or be delighted by something
Example: *Me encantan las fresas*. (I love strawberries)
- **Fascinar** – to be fascinated by or deeply love something
Example: *A María le fascina la cultura japonesa*. (María loves Japanese culture)

These verbs follow the exact same pattern as *gustar* and use *me, te, le, nos, les* with either the third person singular or plural form (*encanta/encantan, fascina/fascinan*).

Liking or Disliking People (Non-Romantic):

Using *gustar* to talk about liking people can imply romantic interest, even if you don't mean it that way. Instead, use the expression:

- **Caer bien / caer mal** – to get along with someone or not
Example: *María me cae bien*. (I like María)
Example: *Juan me cae mal*. (I don't like Juan)

These expressions are used everywhere in the Spanish-speaking world and are safe for non-romantic contexts. They also follow the same structure as *gustar*, where the person being liked is the subject of the verb.

Romantic Liking and Loving People:

If you do mean romantic interest or love, then you can use:

- **Gustar** – to like someone romantically
Example: *Me gusta María*. (I like María – romantically)
- **Amar** – to love (strongest, most direct)
Example: *Yo amo a mi familia*. (I love my family)
Amar is straightforward and uses direct object pronouns when needed.

- **Querer** – to want or love (commonly used for people and pets)
Example: *Te quiero mucho.* (I love you a lot)
Example: *Queremos a nuestros hijos.* (We love our children)
This verb uses the personal “a” with people and pets.